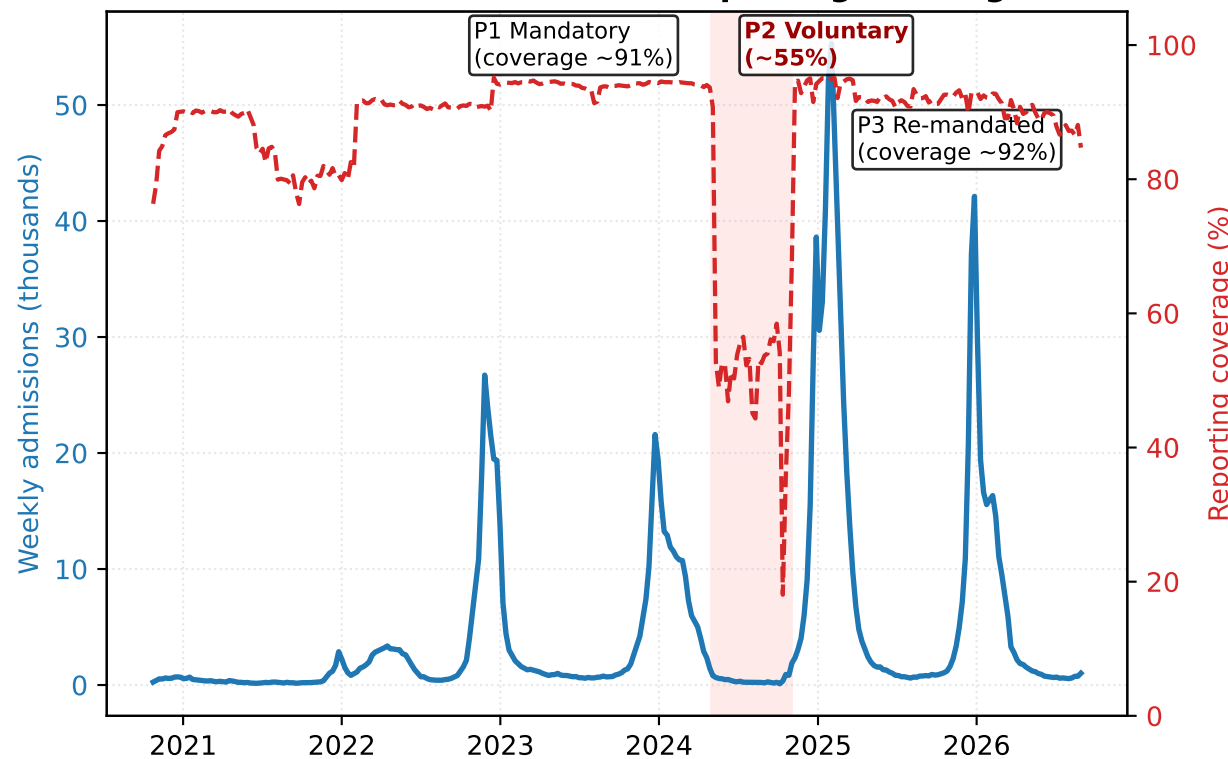
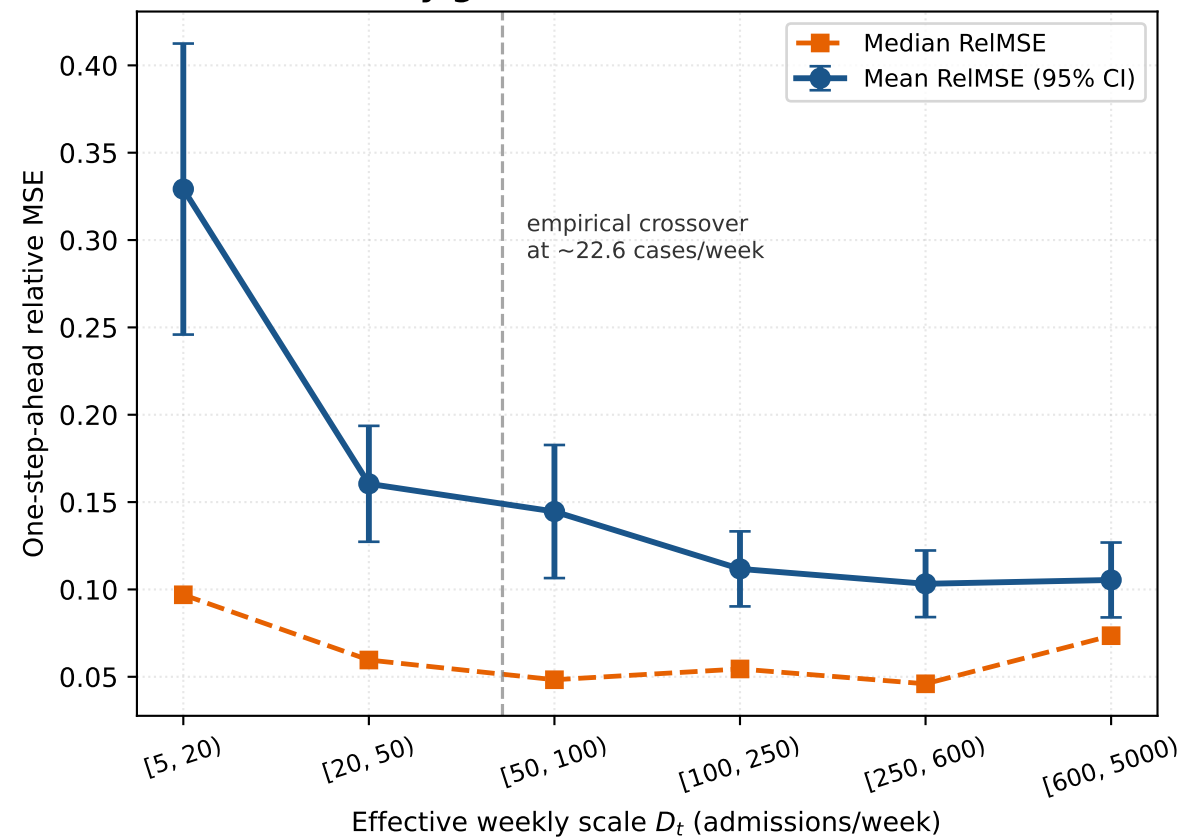
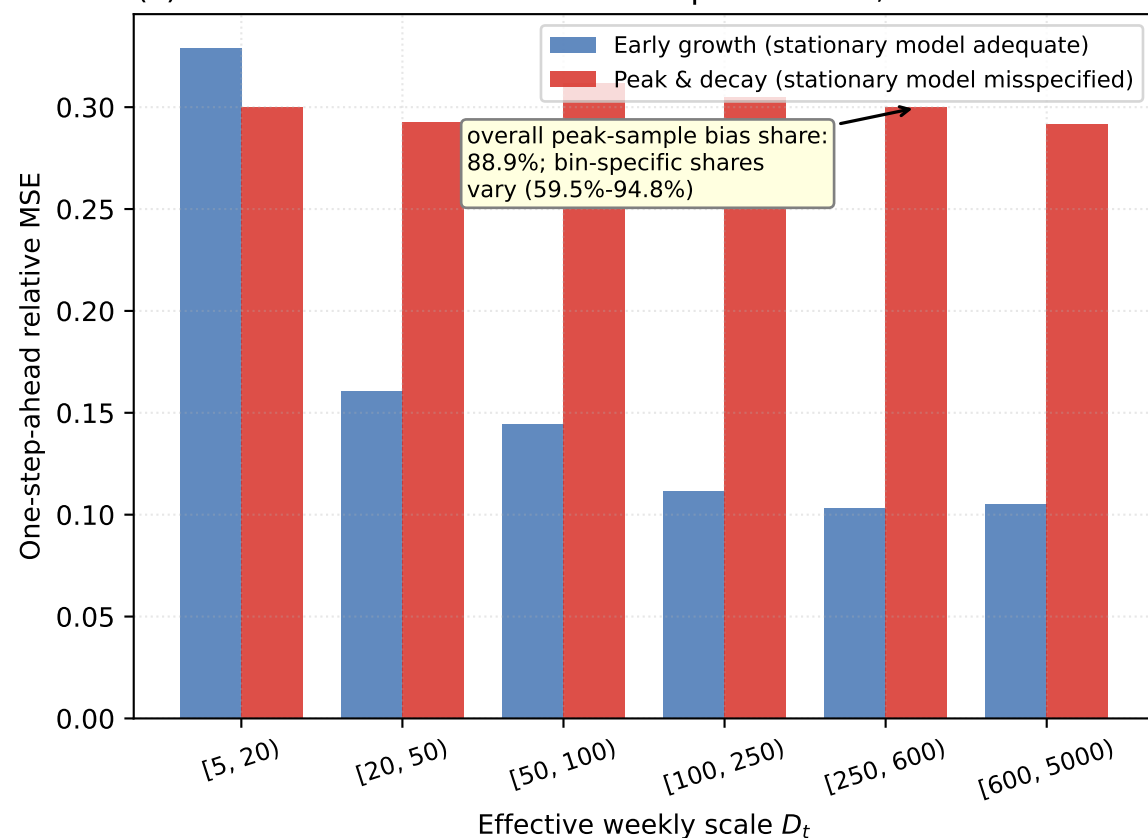


**(a) National admissions & reporting coverage****(b) Early growth: forecast error vs scale****(c) Peak: flat error = baseline misspecification, not scale failure****(d) Tail dispersion across reporting regimes**